



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Veritas Classical Academy

School Website: <https://www.saintsophiaclassical.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Veritas Classical Academy (Norman, OK, 73072) (as represented in the school-specific crawl of St. Sophia Classical Academy's Norman, OK site in the provided crawl data) presents a robust Classical education profile rooted in a Christian, classical framework. Across categories, the public materials emphasize the liberal arts, Great Books, classical languages, and a pedagogy that marries traditional teacher-led instruction with opportunities for Socratic-like discourse in upper grades. The school positions itself as partnership-based with families, integrates theology and liturgical sensibilities, and frames the teacher as a living example of virtue within a shared public mission. Based on the evidence available in the crawl content, the six-category rubric yields CLASSICAL across all six domains, with strong alignment to the core Six Essential Elements of a Classical School.

Key insights - Religious/metaphysical foundations are explicit and persistent (Gospel/theology, liturgical rhythm, sacred music), aligning with transcendental moral realism and a Christian worldview. - School purpose and goal center on formation of virtue and wisdom, not mere job-readiness, with explicit reference to truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable. - Curriculum emphasizes Latin/Greek, liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, and an integrated, wonder-filled approach to learning. - Pedagogy blends contemplative elements with rigorous discussion and rhetoric training, including upper-level seminars/debate and public speaking opportunities. - Faculty are framed as living exemplars and partners in the learning journey; the public materials highlight a faculty culture and living-curriculum metaphor. - Parent and community partnerships are central, with explicit invitations for family participation, formation, and access to school events.

Citations to the school-specific crawl and the classical-education knowledge base are woven into the evidence sections below. See inline citations after the points to locate the exact sources.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials frame education in partnership with families and under Gospel guidance, signaling a theological foundation and explicit Christian framing. For example, the school states it partners with parents and is guided by the Gospel to educate toward the classical tradition. - Descriptions of classical education center the Good, the True, and the Beautiful, with a clear emphasis on virtue and spiritual formation as part of the aims of education. This is articulated in material describing classical education as the cultivation of wisdom and virtue through contemplation of the Good, the True, and the Beautiful. - The pedagogy and curriculum materials reference sacred music, Christian formation, and liturgical sensibilities as part of the student experience.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: gospel/Christian, theology, sacred music, liturgy, truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, divine order, transcendence. The lexicon sections for this element emphasize truth/goodness/beauty, theology, liturgy, reverence, and liturgical practices as core signals of a classical—religious metaphysical—orientation. - Negative indicators: None evident in the crawl data (no explicit secular relativism or value-neutral framing detected in the school's public materials).

Why this rating - The materials consistently present a religious-metaphysical frame (Gospel-guided formation, Christian worldview) and explicit emphasis on transcendentals (truth/goodness/beauty). This aligns strongly with the Classical School criterion for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. The explicit-theological and liturgical elements corroborate a Classical orientation rather than a secular or secularized framing.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials describe formation of virtue and wisdom as the core goal of education, not merely vocational or information transfer. The classical mission is framed as forming character and intellect through a liberal education aligned with truth, goodness, and beauty. - The mission statements emphasize human excellence and the cultivation of wisdom and virtue through the liberal arts and encounter with great books. This is consistent with the classical paideia aim beyond workforce preparation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education/paideia, truth/goodness/beauty, great conversation, human flourishing. These map directly to the Positive Keywords in the knowledge-base lexicon for the "Purpose and Goal" category. - Negative indicators: None evident in the crawl data.

Why this rating - The school explicitly foregrounds formation and virtue as educational telos, with references to the liberal arts and the Great Books as core means to that telos. This aligns with the Classical rubric's emphasis on formation over mere information and on pursuit of the true, the good, and the beautiful.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum explicitly includes classical languages (Latin and Greek) and the liberal arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric). The Great Books approach and the Great Conversation are cited in the classical education descriptions. - There is explicit mention of Great Books and a structured study of classical/Christian studies, history, literature, geography, and related disciplines within a connected, cross-cut curriculum, rather than a purely "social studies" framing. - Public materials reference Memoria Press curriculum and foundational classical languages as central to the program.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; quadrivium concepts implicitly via classical pedagogy), Great Books/Great Conversation, Latin, Greek, classical languages, integrated history/history-literature linkage, wonder/curiosity. The lexicon for Curriculum highlights Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Latin/Greek, and an integrated, wonder-full approach to education. - Negative indicators: None evident; the materials present a coherent, classical curriculum rather than a modern, skills-first framing.

Why this rating - The school's curriculum centers on classical content and methods (grammar-logic-rhetoric; Latin/Greek; Great Books; integrated study across history, literature, and philosophy), with explicit emphasis on wonder and a historically informed canon. This matches the classical Curriculum criteria robustly.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Upper grades are described as engaging in passionate discussion and debate guided by a master teacher, signaling Socratic/Socratic-influenced pedagogy and rhetoric training. This aligns with the higher-grade classical pedagogy model. - The materials describe a traditional classroom approach with leading teachers, disciplined yet purposeful, and a prior emphasis on the liberal arts and memorization/recitation in the broader classical context. - The Great Books/Philosophical tradition is presented as the pedagogical backbone, with reading and discussion anchored in classical texts. - The curricular structure references training in rhetoric and opportunities to give speeches and use rhetoric training, consistent with a classical pedagogy in the upper grades.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, seminars, rhetoric, recitation/memory work, disciplined discussion, master-teacher model, formation through imitation

and practice. The lexicon lists these as core signals for Classical pedagogy. - Negative indicators: The crawl data does not emphasize exclusive project-based or student-led only (constructivist) pedagogy; rather it shows a balanced blend with teacher-led, Socratic elements. This supports CLASSICAL rather than NOT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The presence of master-teacher guided Socratic discussion in upper grades, emphasis on rhetoric and public speaking, and a traditional/classical approach to pedagogy align with the category's Classical criteria.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are described as living exemplars who model virtue, skill, and knowledge; the text highlights a culture where teachers function as mentors within a living-curriculum framework. - Public materials show faculty profiles and emphasis on teacher quality, long-term relationship with students, and a culture of mentorship. - The mission emphasizes partnership with families and faculty as core to the school's life, indicating a community of like-minded colleagues who model virtue and knowledge.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: living curriculum, teacher as mentor, portrait of teacher, faculty collaboration, high caliber/advanced degrees cited in some materials (e.g., faculty descriptions). The lexicon lists positive signals like living curriculum, master-teacher model, moral exemplars, and collegial culture as core faculty signals. - Negative indicators: None evident in the crawl data.

Why this rating - The school materials consistently cast teachers as models of virtue and knowledge and frame the faculty as central to the classical educational experience, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for the Faculty category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families and describes itself as being in partnership with parents, not merely a service provider, with a pathway for parent involvement and training. - Content discusses parent formation, book clubs, gatherings, and making the school accessible for visits, indicating ongoing parental engagement and community education. - The public materials present a sense of community and family integration (e.g., shared rituals, liturgical sensibilities, and a strong community ethos).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: partnership with families, parent formation, parent-teacher collaboration, openness to visits, classical family culture, community of learners. The Six Elements lexicon highlights parent partnership and community involvement as essential signals for a classical school, and the lexicon codifies these as Positive Keywords in Element 6. - Negative indicators: None evident in the crawl data.

Why this rating - The school's explicit focus on parent partnership, family formation, and open campus/community access aligns strongly with the Parents & Community category's Classical signals.

Aggregate assessment - All six categories meet CLASSICAL criteria based on keyword-driven evidence and alignment with the Six Essential Elements. The aggregate classification for Veritas Classical Academy (Norman, OK, 73072) is CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - Not required. All six categories are CLASSICAL based on the available public materials and the classical-education knowledge base signals. If one wanted to push toward a stronger, ultra-precise "Great Books-first" articulation, the school could highlight explicit Great Books lists and a formal Great Conversation framework in its public materials, and further foreground explicit Socratic seminar practices with a defined schedule for all grade bands. Additionally, a more explicit articulation of liturgical practices (daily chapel, calendar observances) could reinforce the liturgical-foundations category, though it is already present in the existing materials.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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